largest in the country) and flew in extra doctors from Indonesia and Turkey. In addition to this outpouring of medical aid, it built approximately 1,000 shelters and brought in generators to provide electricity.[68] Because JuD's response was so quick and comprehensive, the Pakistani state relied heavily on it to carry out aspects of the relief work. That Lashkar was considered the most reliable jihadi outfit did not hurt either, especially considering the government's desire to exercise strict control over the militants involved in the relief effort.

One consequence was to marginalize local, secular NGOs, which international organizations bypassed given the government-approved contributions Islamist outfits were already making. According to JuD communiqués, and confirmed by independent reports, it worked closely with the World Food Program [WFP], World Health Organization [WHO], United Nations Children's Fund [UNICEF], United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees [UNHCR], and the Red Cross [ICRC]. These organizations had copious relief materials, but JuD provided the manpower to help deliver them.[69] For example, it distributed US relief aid and ran some of the camps where UNHCR supplies were distributed.[70] Some of the group's members even ferried NATO soldiers across rivers when the need arose.[71]

These efforts enhanced the group's reputation as a premier social welfare organization. In return, it received accolades from the population as well as members of the government, including Musharraf.[72] In a typical example of the kind of praise offered by survivors, one woman who was rescued said, 'If Dawa people hadn't helped us, we would have died. Nobody else came to help us. We are grateful to them and we offer them our support back.'[73] Pakistan-administered Kashmir's President Lt.-General (Retd) Sardar Mohammad Anwar Khan visited Lashkar's camp in the city of Muzaffarabad to express his gratitude. On the same day, the Prime Minister of Pakistan-administered Kashmir, Sikandar Hayat Khan received Hafiz Saeed at his official residence in Muzaffarabad and thanked him on behalf of his government.[74] The Prime Minister later attended a JuD conference in Muzaffarabad, where he praised the organization for its public welfare work and for being the first on the scene after the earthquake. He told those assembled 'nobody could do what you did' and